arrests. This is because the RSS has always been obsessed with homogeneity instead of unity. Unity as a concept respects and celebrates diversity. That is why our freedom movement brought people from diverse backgrounds together to liberate the country. In stark contrast, unity in diversity is not tolerable to the RSS–BJP as they constantly seek to flatten out India's rich diversity, whether of language, faith, dress, food habits, culture, ideology and so on.[4] The RSS–BJP's campaign to constrict India's diversities is nothing but a Bharat Todo campaign.

The direct consequence of this deep craze to impose one ideology and one set of ideas on India is that citizens' needs and aspirations have been suppressed for the past ten years. Unemployment, inflation, indebtedness, poverty, hunger and inequalities are at record highs. The socialist traits of our system, such as equality of opportunity, social justice and a strong public sector are being erased. At the same time, free and fair elections, freedom of speech and expression,[5] and the right to dissent[6] are being done away with. Under Prime Minister Modi, attempts are on to replace respect and reverence with hate and contempt. And to cover this all up, like the Modi government did during the G-20 summit when it hid all the shanties and inconvenient symbols of its multiple failures,[7] the BJP government is busy creating the chimera of New India. In reality, the BJP is exclusively serving the interests of monopoly capital, both domestic and foreign, and sacrificing national interests. It can be clearly seen that in New India's new social contract, citizens are being ignored and bypassed. This poses grave challenges to an inclusive democracy such as India, which was so laboriously built over the last seventy years.

It is against this backdrop that the Bharat Jodo Yatra, led by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, emerged as a force in mobilizing millions of Indians who have been put on mute for a decade. The consciousness of millions of Indians, workers, peasants, middle classes and students was roused as they joined the Yatra. They raised crucial issues and showed their resolve for a united and resilient democratic future. The Yatra space was also shared with other Opposition parties who represent major sections of society. The Yatra emerged as a platform for those forces that believed in India's Constitution